Project 4 | charity: water Game Concept

The marketing team at charity: water wants you to mockup a game inspired by their global mission, with the goal of raising awareness among young people.

For your first deliverable, choose from the provided ideas, or come up with a game concept of your own. Then, break down what the game would look like on the screen. Plan core elements like layout, interaction, and feedback. Finally, you'll submit a wireframe or mockup of the game you intend to build.

Step 1: Choose Your Game Idea

Your goal is to decide on a game that would be fun, engaging, and doable for you to build over the next couple weeks. Choose something you'd enjoy working on, and that you would be excited to share in your portfolio later on!

Here are some ideas to get you started (feel free to go with those!) —

- **Water Quest:** A fast-paced, whack-a-mole-style game where players tap charity: water's signature yellow jerry cans to earn points. Include a score counter, feedback messages, milestones, and optional obstacles to make it more engaging.
- **Water Drop:** In this game, users collect as many falling water drops as possible while avoiding pollutants (bad drops). Users tap to collect drops before they hit the ground. Include a score counter, feedback messages, and penalties for "bad drops" to make it more engaging.

Don't like these ideas? Use AI tools to help you brainstorm a game concept, or build on the provided examples. Here's a prompt suggestion:

Try this prompt



I'm designing a simple web app game to promote charity: water's mission of providing clean water for all (see: charitywater.org). The goal is specifically to engage college students. My goal is to create something fun, **[add any specific game elements you'd like]**. It also needs to be simple enough for me to build using HTML, CSS and JS **[add any additional skills or languages]**, with my current skills **[describe skill level]** and in **[add desired time to spend]**. Help me come up with ideas. For each idea, explain the game mechanics and break down what I would need to build.

Remember, brainstorming with AI is a conversation. Be discerning about the results, and don't be afraid to ask follow up questions or correct the AI if what it is suggesting sounds too complicated.

Step 2: Wireframe Your Game

Create a visual wireframe of your game, using hand-drawing or sketching software. Your wireframe should show the key features of your game.

Think about what the player sees: title, score, buttons, progress bars, icons, or avatars. Include all elements, including those as users we take for granted, such as a 'start' button or a feedback message telling the user the game ended. These provide a roadmap for everything you would need to code later.

- **Ready for a LevelUp? (20pts extra credit)**
    - **Use a Wireframing Tool (10pts):** Try out a wireframing tool like Figma, Balsamiq, or Adobe XD (or similar) to wireframe like a pro. Many of these tools offer a free limited-time demo.

- **Wireframe For Different Devices (10pts):** Think of your game being played on mobile screens and laptops. Create wireframes for each to show how screen size will impact the layout and gameplay.

Step 3: Plan the Game Logic

Using the template provided below, write up a short explanation of how the game logic works. Ask yourself: What actions does the player take? What gets updated—score, timer, achievements? What feedback does the player get (e.g., animations, visual cues, milestone unlocks)?

Word of advice: Keep it simple — you will have opportunities to iterate and expand your game later, but done is better than perfect, and you have a deadline! Your initial goal is to get started with something that you can do.

Use AI to verify that your game logic makes sense. Here's a sample prompt:

Try this prompt



Attached is my wireframe of a web game designed to promote charity: water's mission of providing clean water for all (see: charitywater.org). My game logic includes: **[insert description]**. Does this make sense? Identify any weaknesses in my game logic or opportunities for improvement.

As your understanding of the game logic deepens, return to step 2 and adjust your wireframe, removing unnecessary elements and adding new ones.

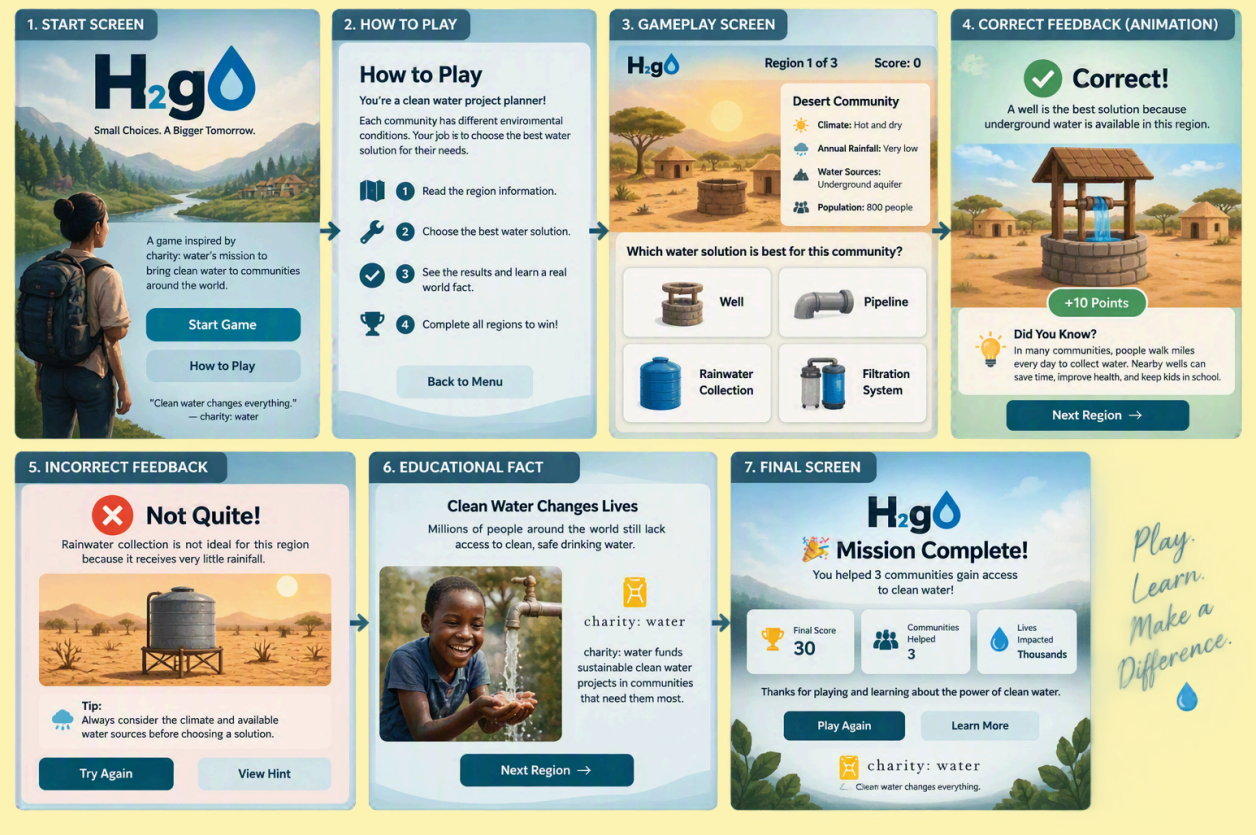
Step 4: Add Branding

When designing a game for an organization looking to increase awareness, it's important to build the brand's assets into the design. Refine your initial sketch by adding colors, icons, and styles that align with **charity: water's brand guidelines**. If you're keeping your wireframe minimal, include notes on where the brand's colors, images, links, or icons will be incorporated.

Step 5: Submit Your Work

Happy with your wireframe or mockup? Capture a clear, high-quality image of your game idea, and complete the following in order to submit your work.

1. Let's see it! Include your game wireframe image here: **(30pt)**



1B. Did you do any of the LevelUps? To help the evaluator notice—and give you the bonus points you deserve!—, please list them here:

2. Fill in the template provided below and paste in a full description of the game logic (how the game works, what users do, what happens when they do it, etc). This description should be written in a no-frills style, as if breaking down the logic that needs to be coded into the game for an engineering team. **(30pt)**

(Write your own game logic below, following the template format 👇)

H2gO - Game Logic

1. Game Start:

- When the game loads, the player is presented with a **Start Screen** containing the game title, a brief description, and buttons for **Start Game** and **How to Play**.
- The score is initialized to **0**.
- The first region (Desert, Tropical, or Mountainous) is loaded.
- The current level is displayed (e.g., "Region 1 of 3").

---

2. Player Actions:

- The player reads information about the community, including:
  - Climate
  - Rainfall
  - Available water sources
  - Population
- The player selects one of four water solutions:
  - Well
  - Pipeline
  - Rainwater Collection
  - Filtration System
- The player clicks a **Submit** button to confirm their choice.
- The game evaluates the choice and displays feedback explaining why the solution is correct or incorrect.
- The player proceeds to the next region by clicking **Next Region**.

---

3. Game Logic:

- Each region has a predefined optimal water solution.
- When a player submits a choice, the game checks whether the selected solution matches the correct answer.
- If the choice is correct:
    - Award points.
    - Display a success message.
    - Show a brief explanation of why the choice was effective.
- If the choice is incorrect:
    - Display an error message.
    - Explain why the solution is not suitable for that environment.
    - Allow the player to try again or continue.
- After completing a region, the game loads the next challenge.

---

4. Score/Feedback:

- Correct answers add **10 points** to the player's score.
- Incorrect answers do not earn points.
- Visual feedback includes:
    - ✅ Green "Correct!" message for successful choices.
    - ❌ Red "Incorrect" message for unsuccessful choices.
    - Updated score display.
    - Progress indicator showing current region.
- Educational facts about global water access and Charity: Water projects are displayed after each challenge.
- Optional audio feedback:
    - Success sound for correct answers.
    - Error sound for incorrect answers.

---

5. Win or Lose Conditions:

Win Condition:

- The player successfully completes all three regions.

- A final score is calculated and displayed.

End of Game:

- A **Mission Complete** screen appears showing:
  - Final Score
  - Number of Communities Helped
  - Educational message about Charity: Water's mission
- The player is congratulated for providing clean water solutions to all communities.

Lose Condition:

- There is no traditional "lose" state in the MVP version.
- The focus is on learning and improving decision-making rather than failure.

---

6. Reset/Replay:

- The player can click **Play Again** from the final screen.
- When the game resets:
  - Score returns to 0.
  - Progress returns to Region 1.
  - All choices are cleared.
  - The game begins from the start screen or first challenge.
- The player can play through the regions again to improve their score and reinforce learning.

3. Write up a note for your charity: water stakeholders describing your game idea. Imagine this as the body of the email that you send along with your wireframe image. Here, your writing can focus less on the nitty-gritty details, and more on the exciting elements of the game and why you believe users will

love it. Highlight how and where charity: water brand assets (colors, images, link to website etc) will be incorporated. Your goal is to get them excited about your idea, and get stakeholder approval to continue building the game! **(10pt)**

(Paste or write your answer below 👇)

Thank you for the opportunity to review our game concept. I am excited to share **H2gO**, an educational web-based game inspired by charity: water's mission to bring clean water to communities around the world.

H2gO is designed specifically for college students and combines strategy, problem-solving, and social impact awareness in a fun and engaging experience. Players take on the role of a clean water project planner and are challenged to provide sustainable water solutions to communities facing different environmental conditions. Instead of simply answering quiz questions, players must analyze each region's climate, terrain, and available water sources before selecting the most effective solution, such as a well, pipeline, rainwater collection system, or filtration system.

What makes H2gO engaging is that players immediately see the impact of their decisions. After making a choice, the game provides visual feedback through animations that demonstrate the outcome of the selected solution. Successful decisions earn points and help communities gain access to clean water, while incorrect choices provide educational explanations that encourage learning and critical thinking. This approach transforms a global issue into an interactive challenge that feels both meaningful and rewarding.

The game also reinforces charity: water's mission throughout the experience. After each challenge, players unlock real-world facts about the global water crisis and learn how clean water projects can improve health, education, and quality of life. By connecting gameplay decisions with real-world outcomes, H2gO helps players better understand the impact of the work charity: water accomplishes every day.

To maintain strong alignment with the charity: water brand, the game will incorporate:

- charity: water's signature yellow and blue color palette throughout the interface
- Photos and imagery inspired by communities positively impacted by clean water access
- Educational content highlighting charity: water's work and global impact
- A direct link to the charity: water website for players interested in learning more
- Branding and messaging that reinforces the organization's mission of providing clean water for all

Our proposed MVP focuses on a simple but compelling gameplay loop: analyze a community, choose a water solution, receive visual feedback, learn a real-world fact, and continue to the next challenge. This focused design keeps development achievable while delivering an engaging experience that effectively communicates the importance of clean water access.

We believe H2gO has the potential to connect with college students by combining meaningful social impact with interactive gameplay. Rather than simply teaching players about the water crisis, the game allows them to actively participate in solving it, creating a memorable experience that increases awareness of charity: water's mission and inspires further engagement.

We look forward to your feedback and hope to move forward with development of H2gO. Thank you for considering our proposal.

4. Reflect on the experience of wireframing and planning a game. What surprised you? How did you use AI to assist you? What did you learn from this experience? What would you do differently next time? **(10 pt)**

(Paste or write your answer below 👇)

I really enjoyed this assignment and felt that it was an excellent use of class time. The wireframing and planning process was enjoyable because it allowed me to think creatively while also focusing on how a game would function from a user's perspective. One thing that surprised me was how much planning goes into a game before any actual coding begins. I had always assumed that most of the work happened during development, but I learned that a well-thought-out design can make the development process much smoother.

AI played a significant role in helping me brainstorm ideas and organize my thoughts. I started with a concept that was much more complicated, but AI helped me refine the idea and bring it back within the scope of the assignment. It suggested game mechanics, features, user feedback systems, and wireframe layouts that aligned with both the educational goals of the project and my current skill level. Having AI act as a brainstorming partner allowed me to explore ideas more quickly than I could have on my own.

Through this experience, I learned the importance of focusing on a minimum viable product (MVP). Instead of trying to include every feature I could think of, I learned to prioritize the features that were most important to the core gameplay experience. I also gained a better understanding of user interface design, navigation, and how feedback systems help keep players engaged.

If I were to do this project again, I would spend more time sketching out multiple game concepts before choosing one. While I am happy with the direction I chose, exploring additional ideas could have helped me compare different approaches before committing to a final design. Overall, this experience increased my confidence in game planning and design, and I am excited to continue developing H2gO over the next few weeks.

— Save and submit your work!

Great work completing this Project! To submit your work, download / export this document as a PDF and then upload it to the Project

submission page on HQ. You can find the option to download as a PDF from the File menu in the upper-left corner of the Google Doc interface.